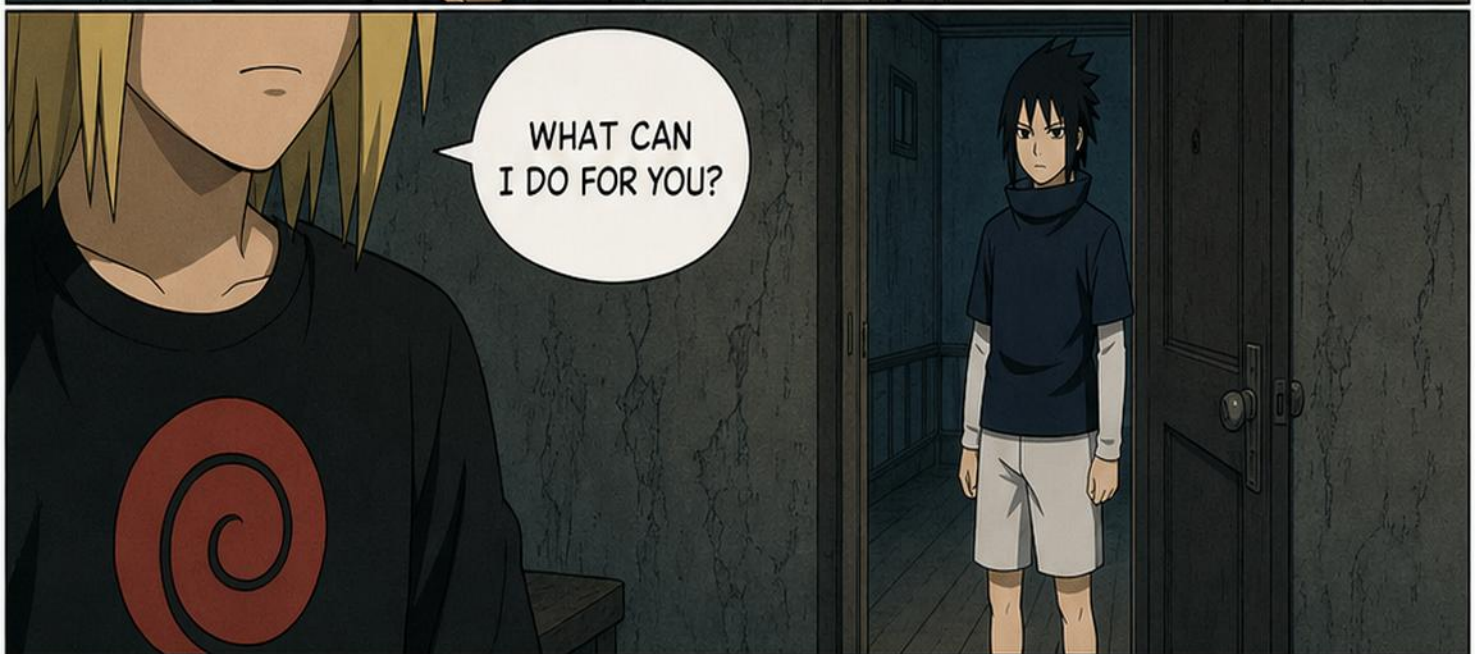
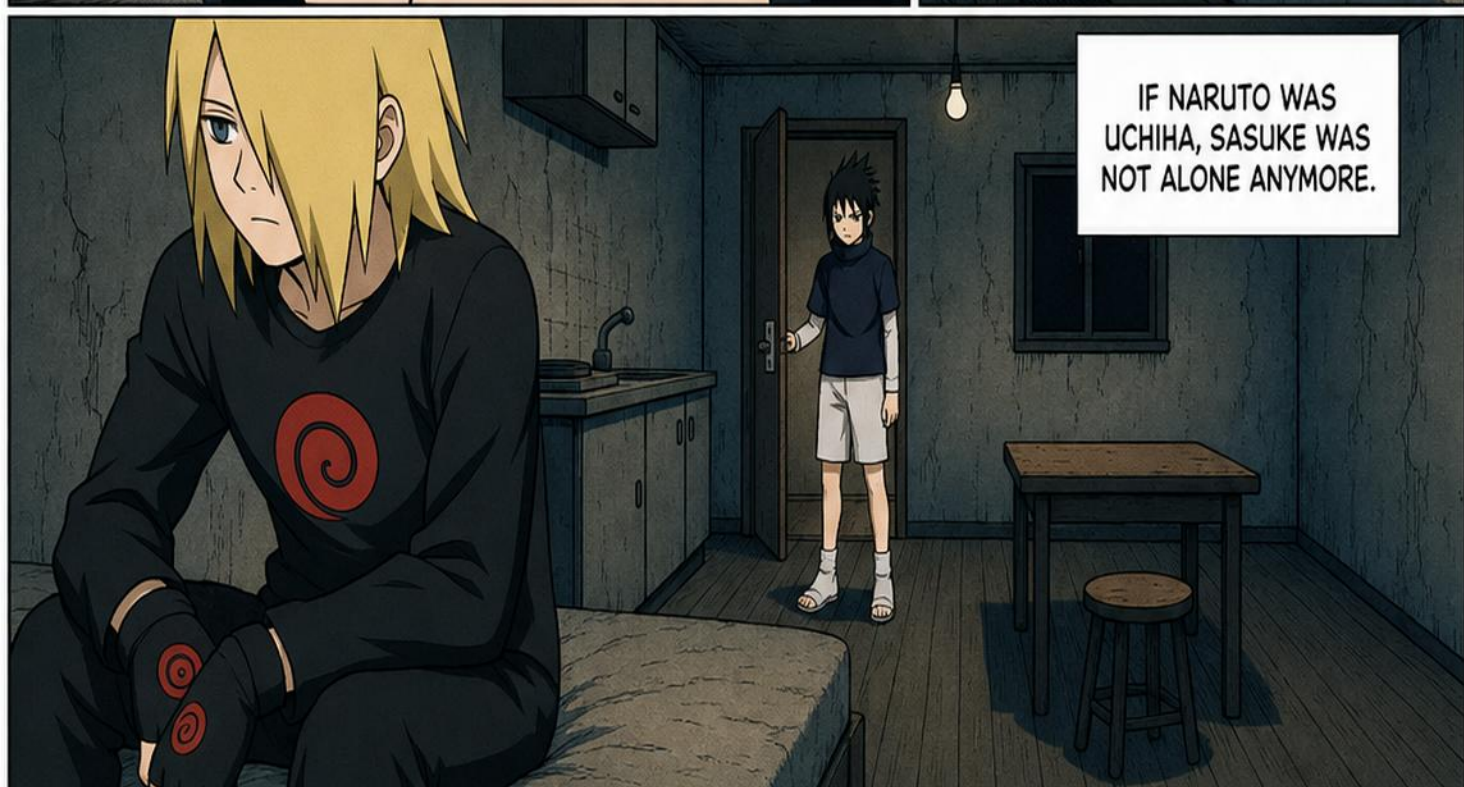
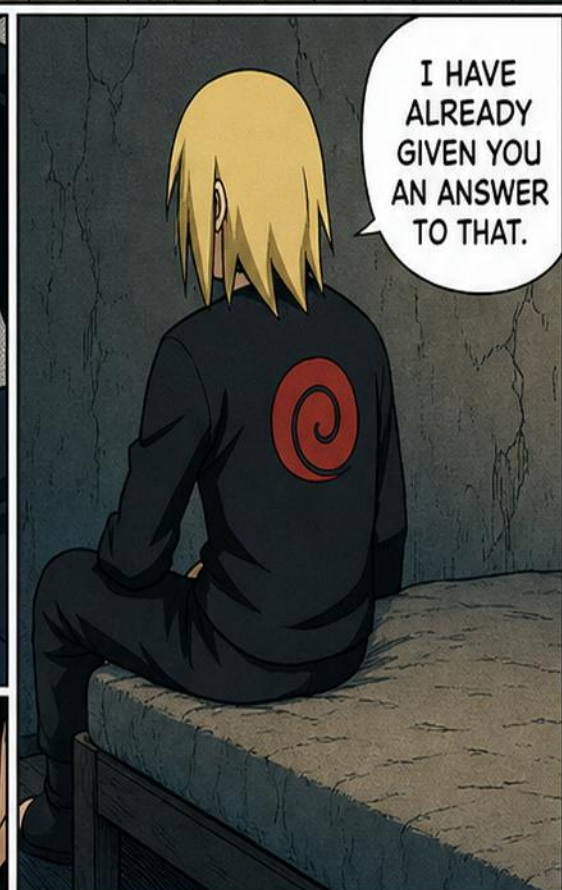
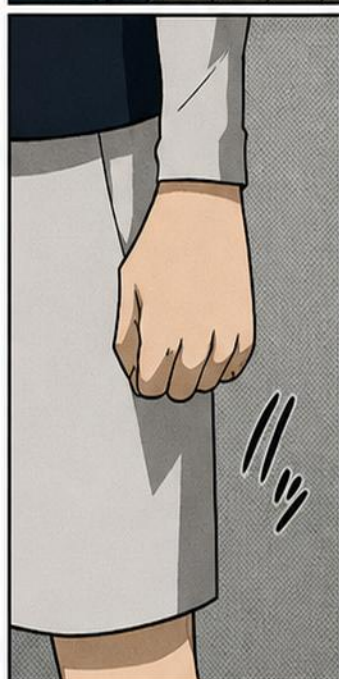


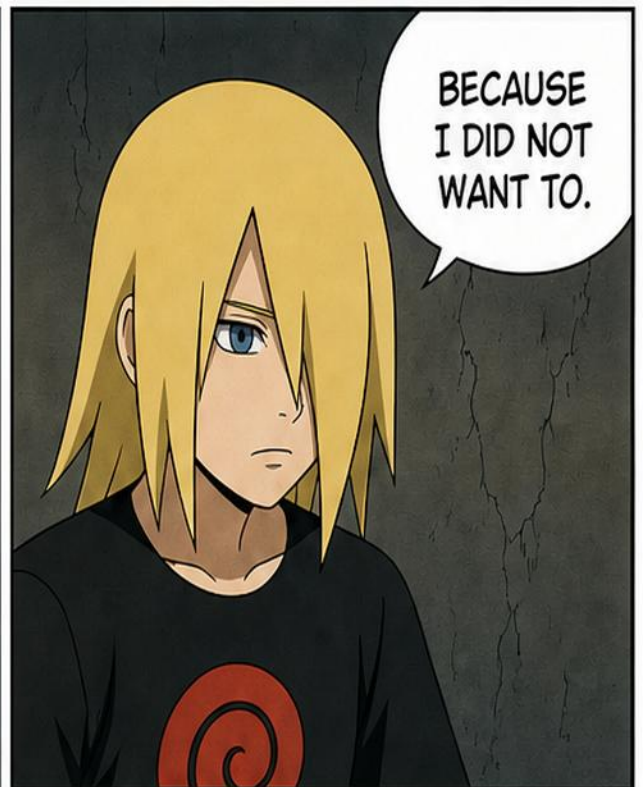
HE HAD ENEMIES
TO PREPARE HIMSELF
FOR. KONOHA COULD
WAIT.





A medium shot of Sasuke Uchiwa sitting on a stool in a dark room, facing Sakura Haruno. He is wearing a black shirt with a red spiral symbol. Sakura is seen from the back, wearing a dark blue hoodie with a red and white circular symbol on the back. A single light bulb hangs from the ceiling.

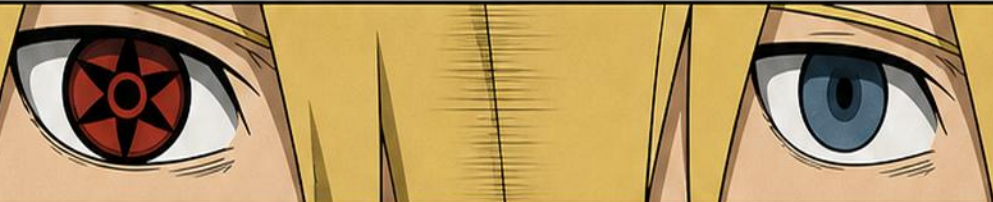
WHY DIDN'T
YOU EVER
SAY ANYTHING
TO ME?

A close-up of Sakura Haruno with her blonde hair and blue eyes. She has a serious expression and is wearing a black shirt with a red spiral symbol.

BECAUSE
I DID NOT
WANT TO.

A close-up of Sasuke Uchiwa with a determined and slightly angry expression. He is looking directly at Sakura.

WHO DID
YOU KILL TO
AWAKEN
THEM?

A wide shot of Sasuke Uchiwa sitting at a wooden table in a dark room. He is wearing a black shirt with a red spiral symbol. In the background, there is a sink, a window, and a bed.

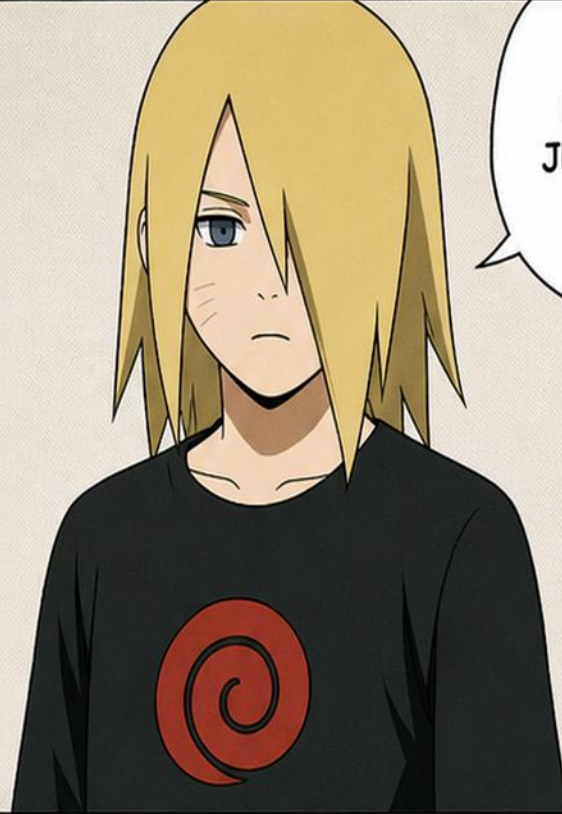
THE NAKA
SHRINE. YOU
ARE MAKING
USE OF IT.

A medium shot of Sasuke Uchiwa looking surprised and slightly concerned. He is leaning forward, and a sweat drop is visible on his forehead. The room's interior, including the sink and bed, is visible in the background.

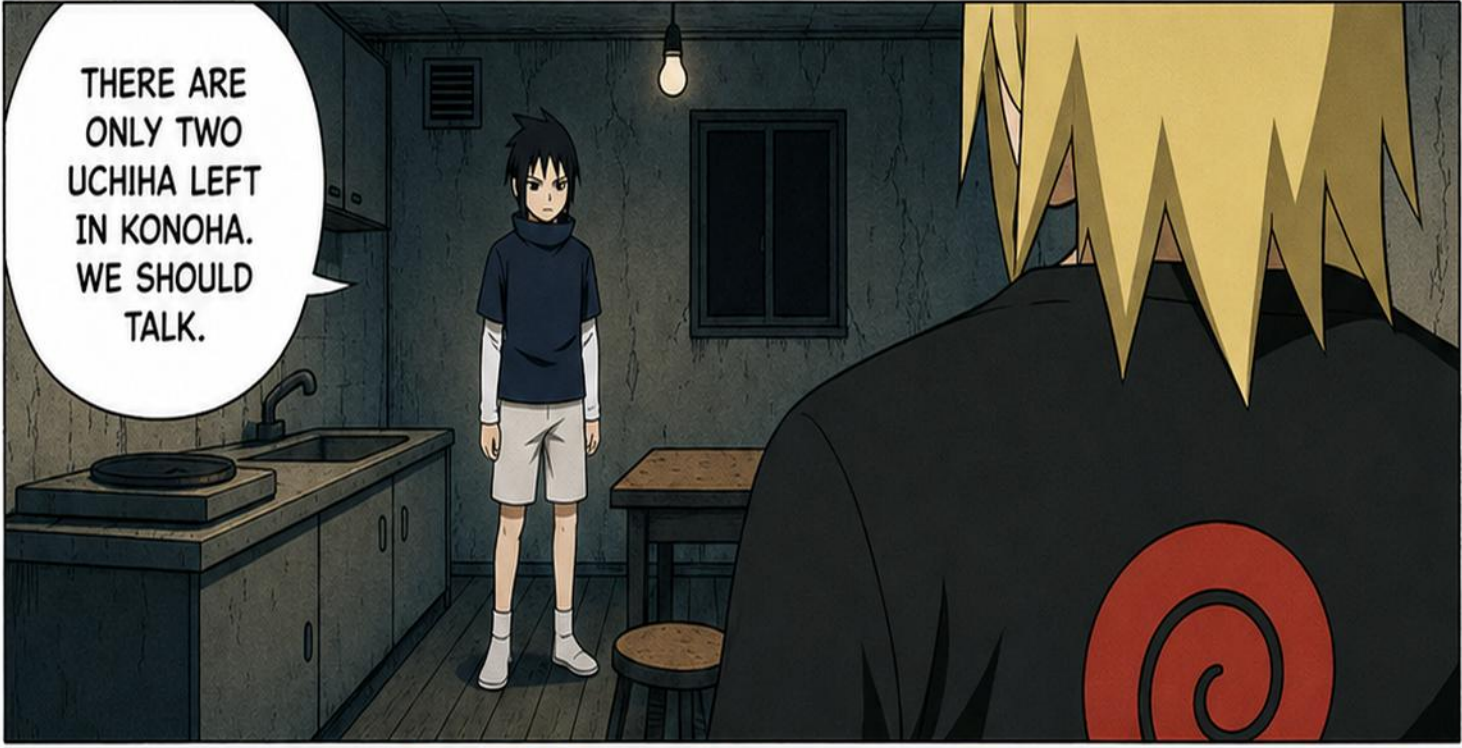
YOU KNOW
ABOUT IT?
HOW?

A close-up of Sasuke Uchiha with his signature black spiky hair and a dark blue turtleneck. He has a serious, somewhat angry expression.

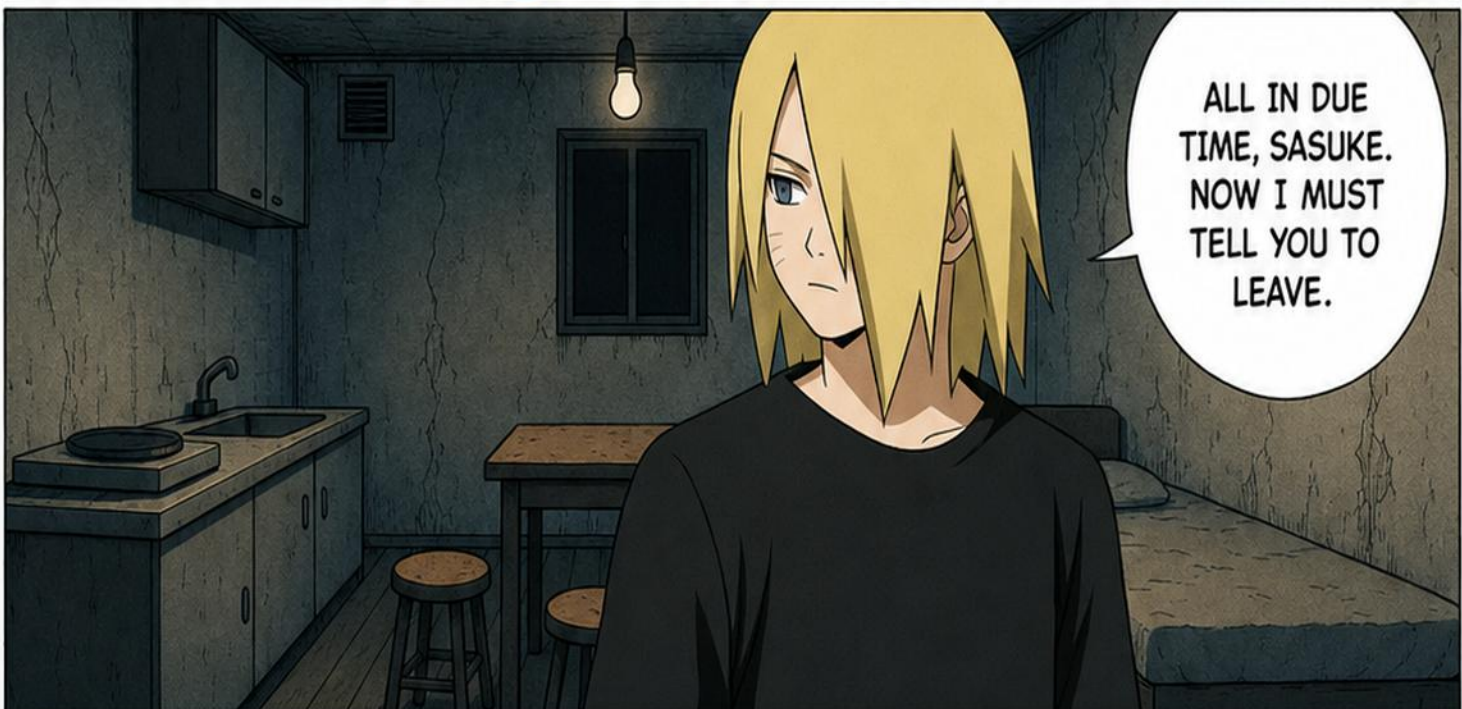
I REALLY
DON'T LIKE
YOU, NARUTO.

A close-up of Kushina Uzumaki with her long blonde hair and a black t-shirt featuring a red spiral symbol. She looks calm but firm.

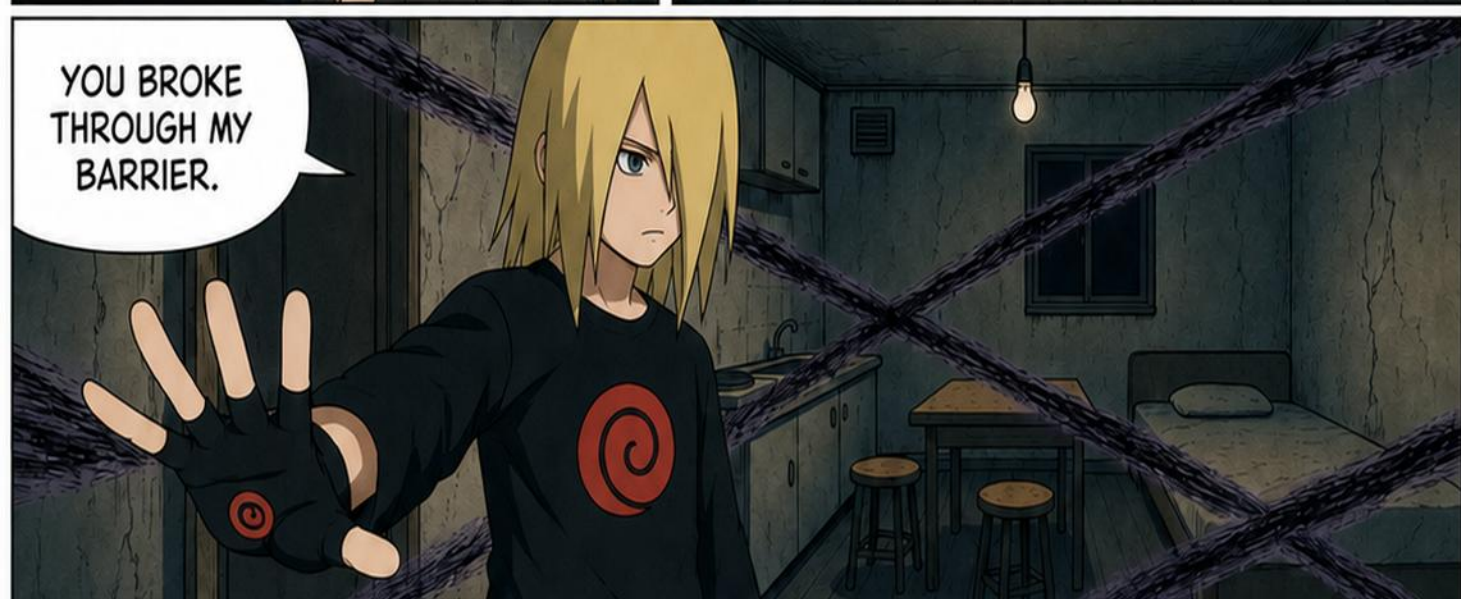
NO. YOU
JUST ENVY
ME.

A wider shot of the kitchen. Sasuke stands in the background near a sink and stove. In the foreground, the back of Kushina's head and shoulders are visible, showing her blonde hair and the red spiral on her shirt.

THERE ARE
ONLY TWO
UCHIHA LEFT
IN KONOHA.
WE SHOULD
TALK.

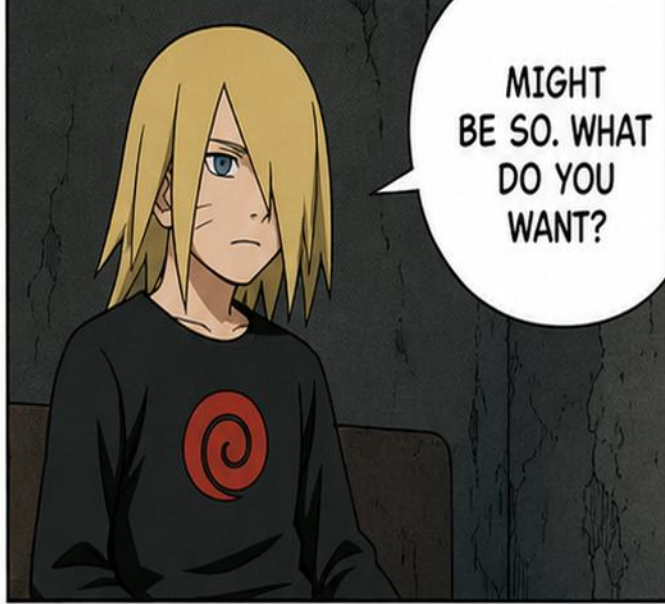
A shot of Kushina in the kitchen, looking towards Sasuke. The background shows the same kitchen setting with a sink, stove, and a window.

ALL IN DUE
TIME, SASUKE.
NOW I MUST
TELL YOU TO
LEAVE.

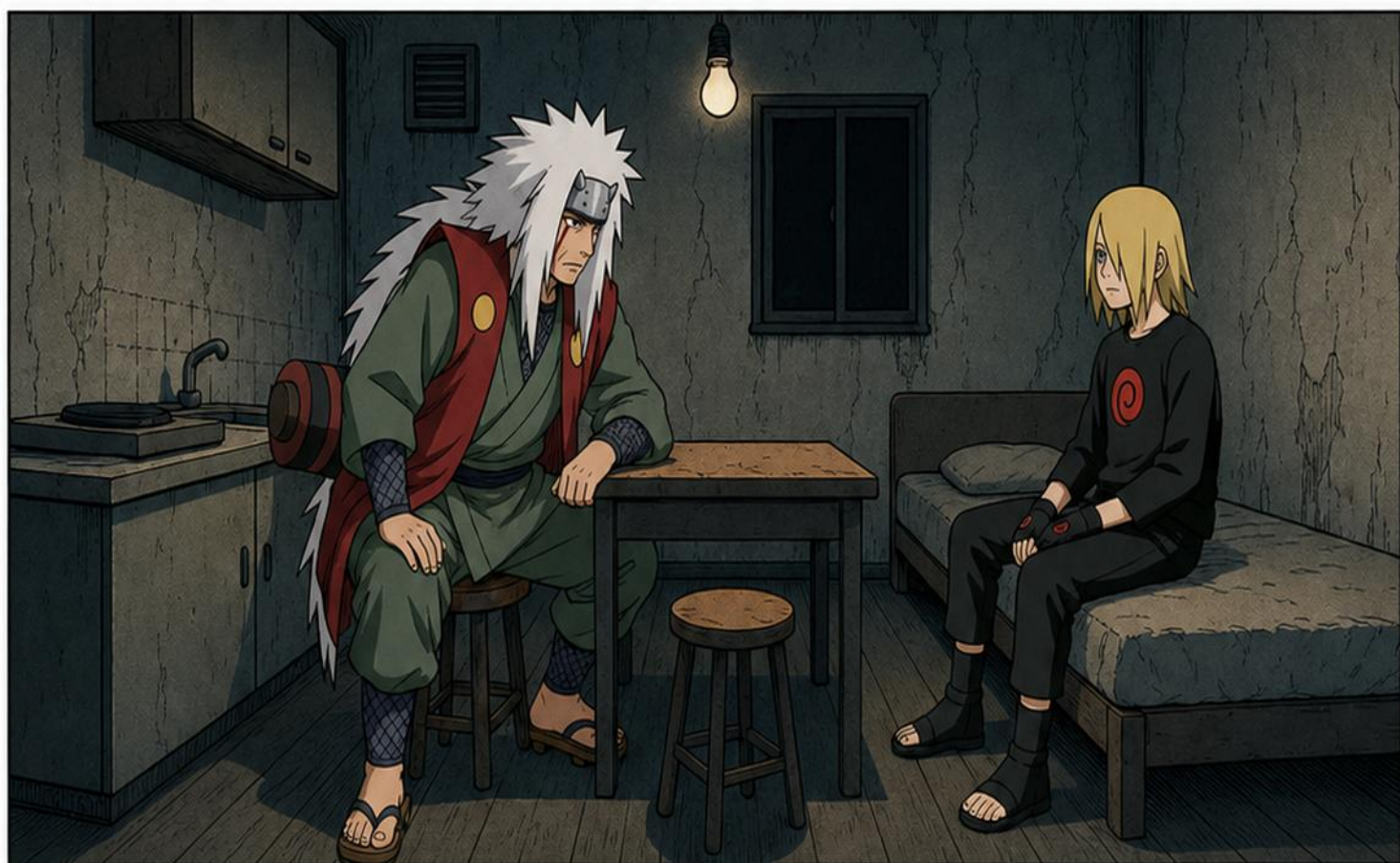


Mifune, an elderly man with long white hair and a metal headband, stands in a doorway. He wears a green robe with a red sash and a yellow circular emblem. He looks into the room with a serious expression.

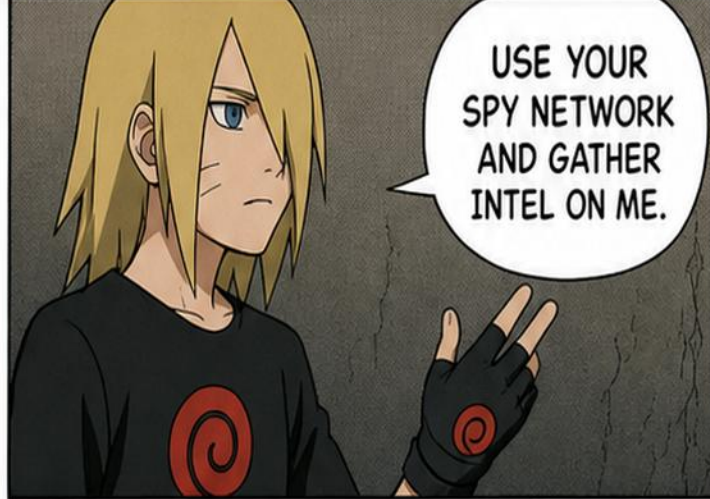
WHAT
COULD YOU
HAVE HIDDEN
IN HERE?

Naruto Uzumaki, with his signature blonde hair and blue eyes, sits on a wooden bench. He wears a black long-sleeved shirt with a red spiral emblem on the chest.

MIGHT
BE SO. WHAT
DO YOU
WANT?

A close-up of Mifune's face. He has a stern, somewhat angry expression, with his white hair and metal headband clearly visible.

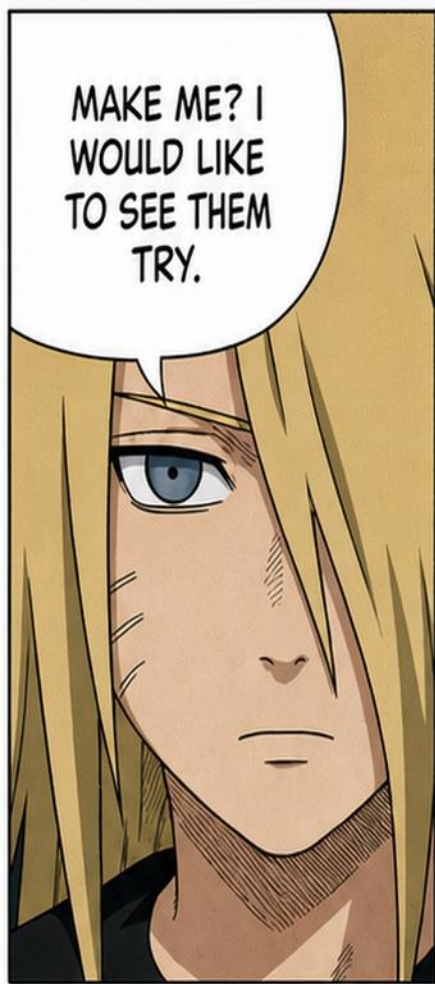
HOW CAN YOU
USE THE
SHARINGAN?
I KNEW BOTH
OF YOUR
PARENTS.

A close-up of Naruto's face. He looks calm but determined, with his hand raised in a peace sign gesture.

USE YOUR
SPY NETWORK
AND GATHER
INTEL ON ME.

A close-up of Mifune's face, showing his intense gaze and the details of his headband and hair.

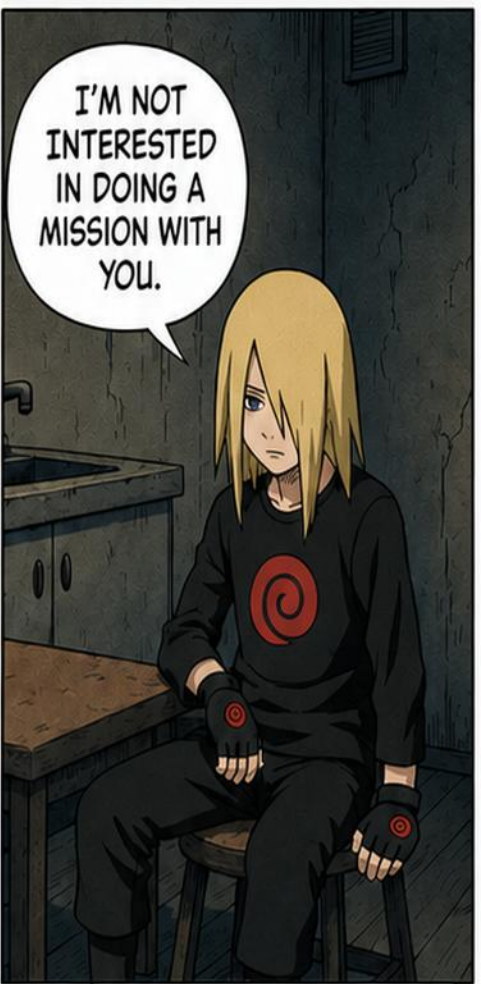
THE
COUNCIL MAY
FORCE SOMEONE
TO ENTER
YOUR MIND.



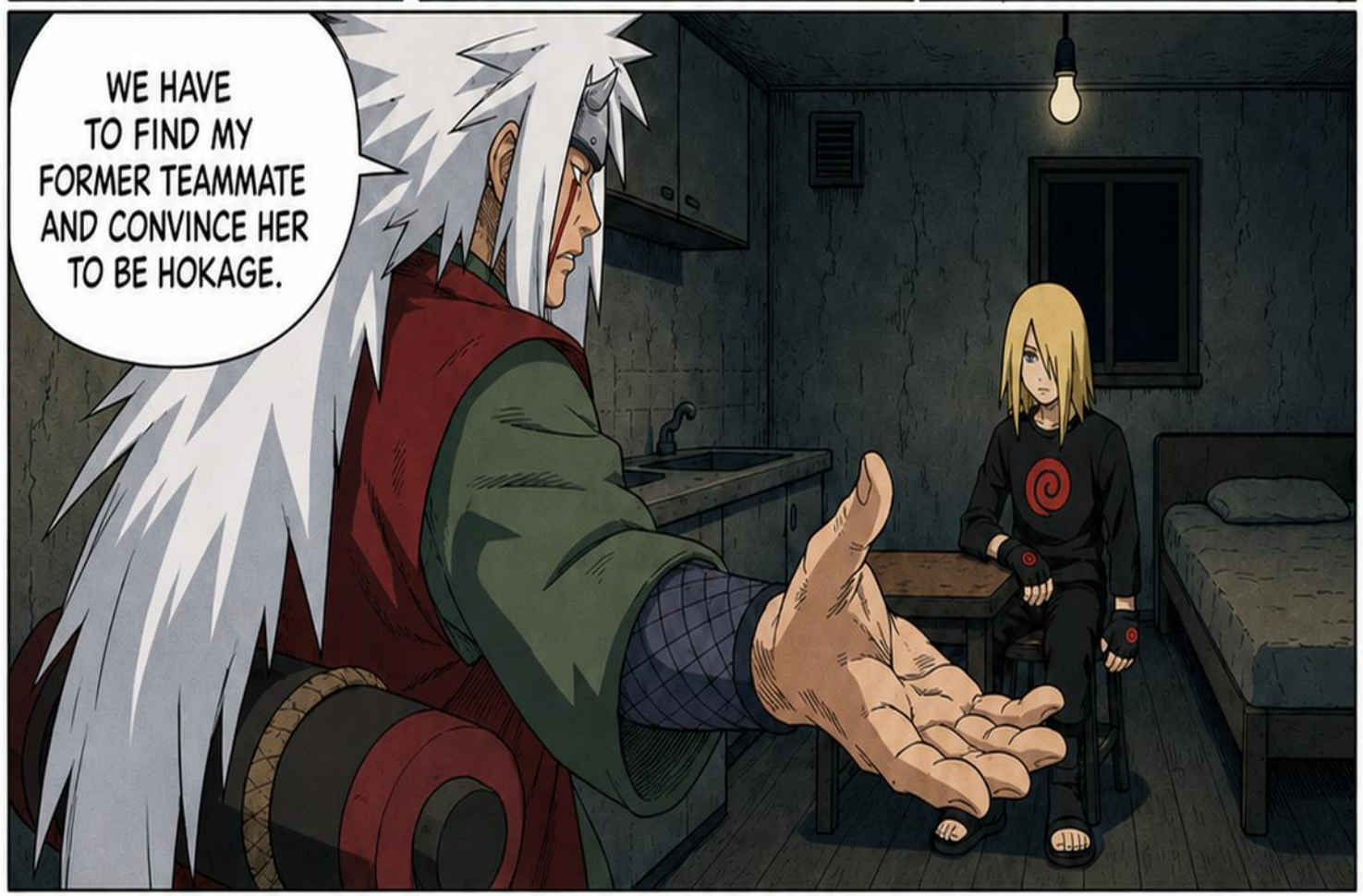
MAKE ME? I
WOULD LIKE
TO SEE THEM
TRY.



I CAME
WITH YOU
FOR A MISSION
WHICH YOU WILL
DO WITH ME.



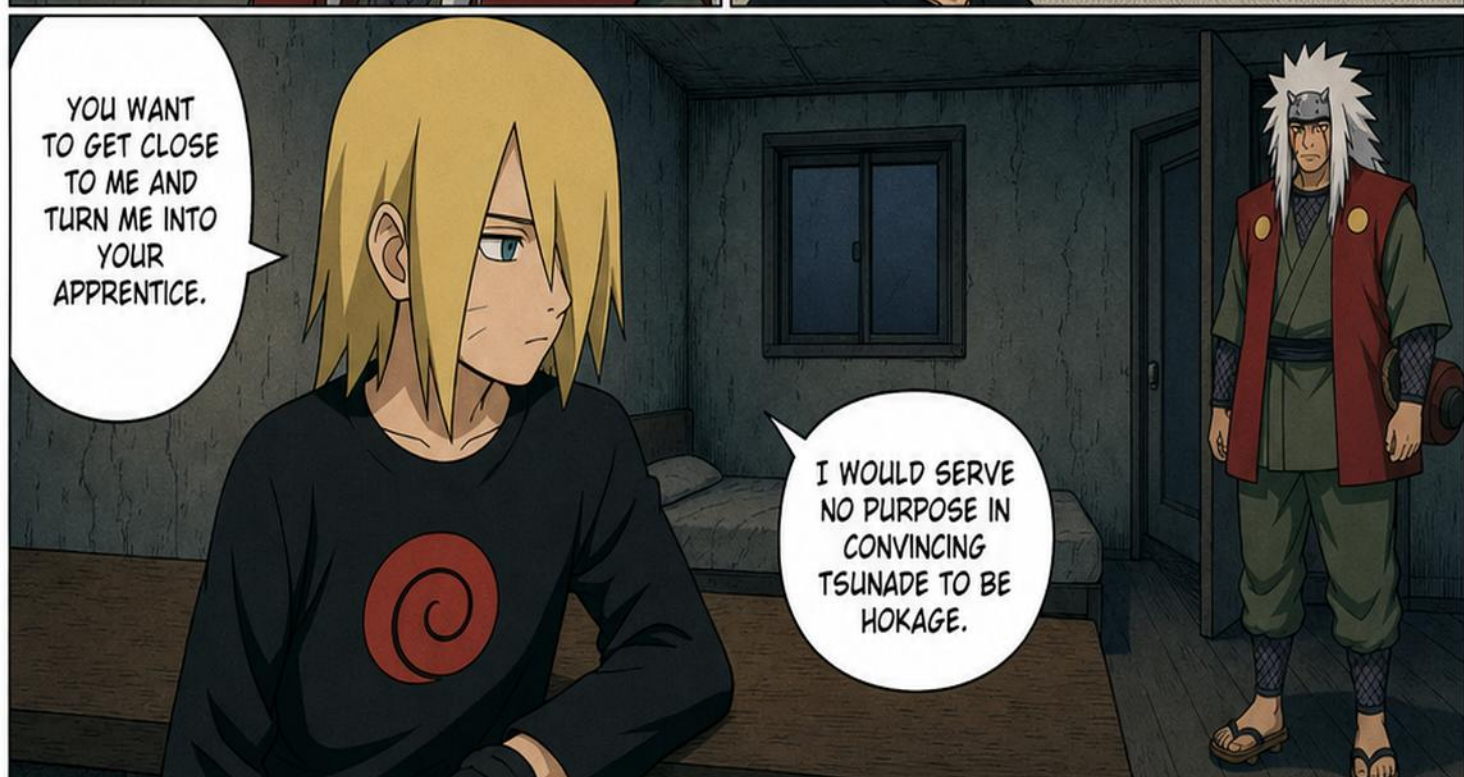
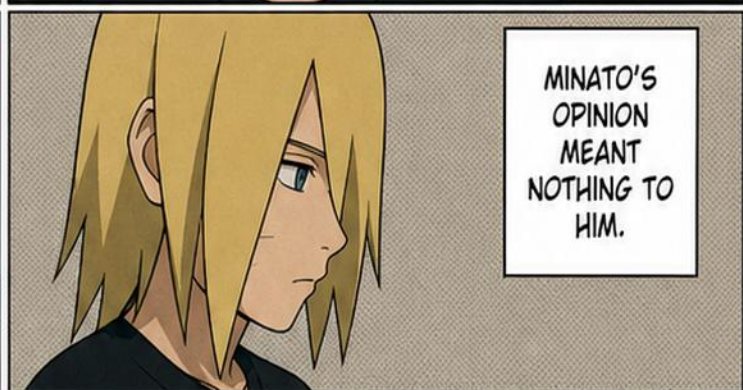
I'M NOT
INTERESTED
IN DOING A
MISSION WITH
YOU.



WE HAVE
TO FIND MY
FORMER TEAMMATE
AND CONVINCE HER
TO BE HOKAGE.



IF YOU FORCE
ME OUTSIDE THE
VILLAGE, I WON'T
RETURN.

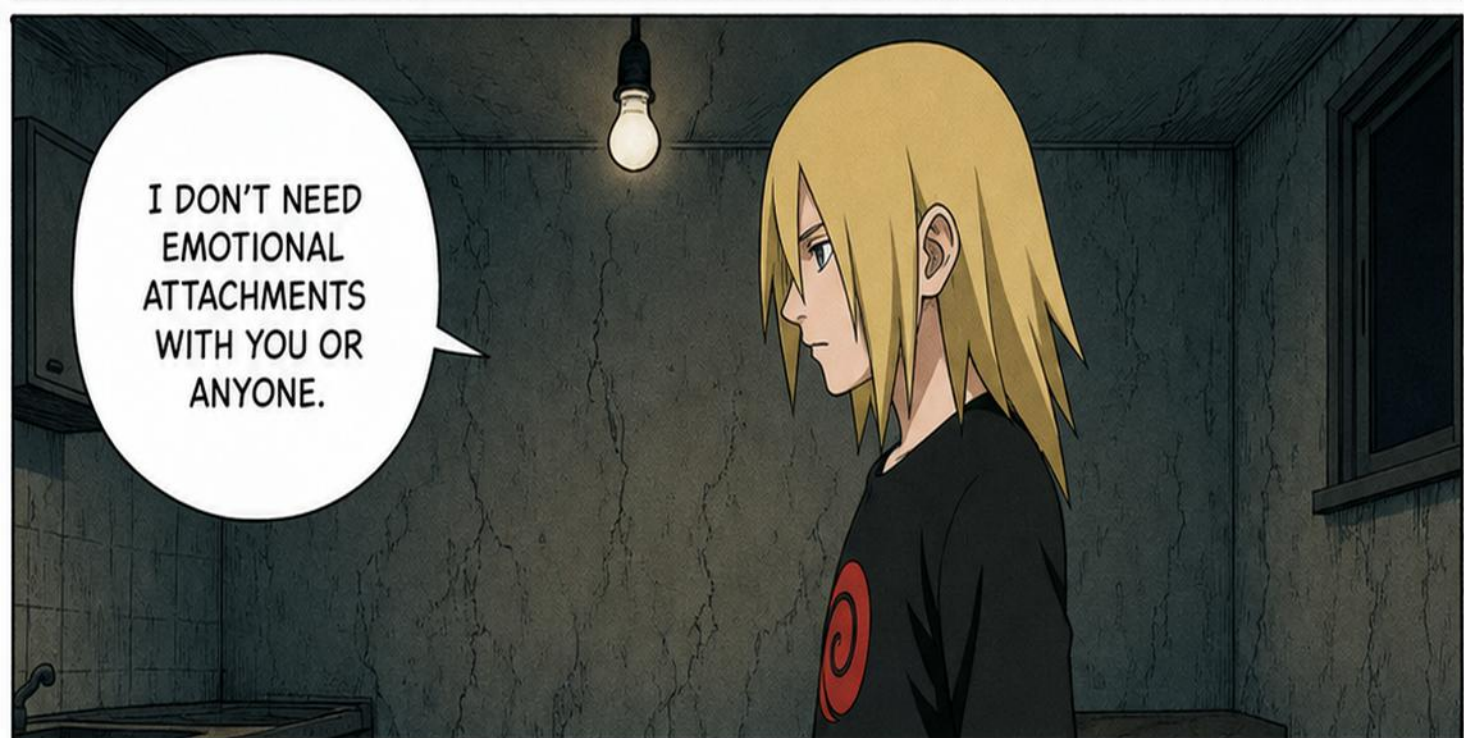




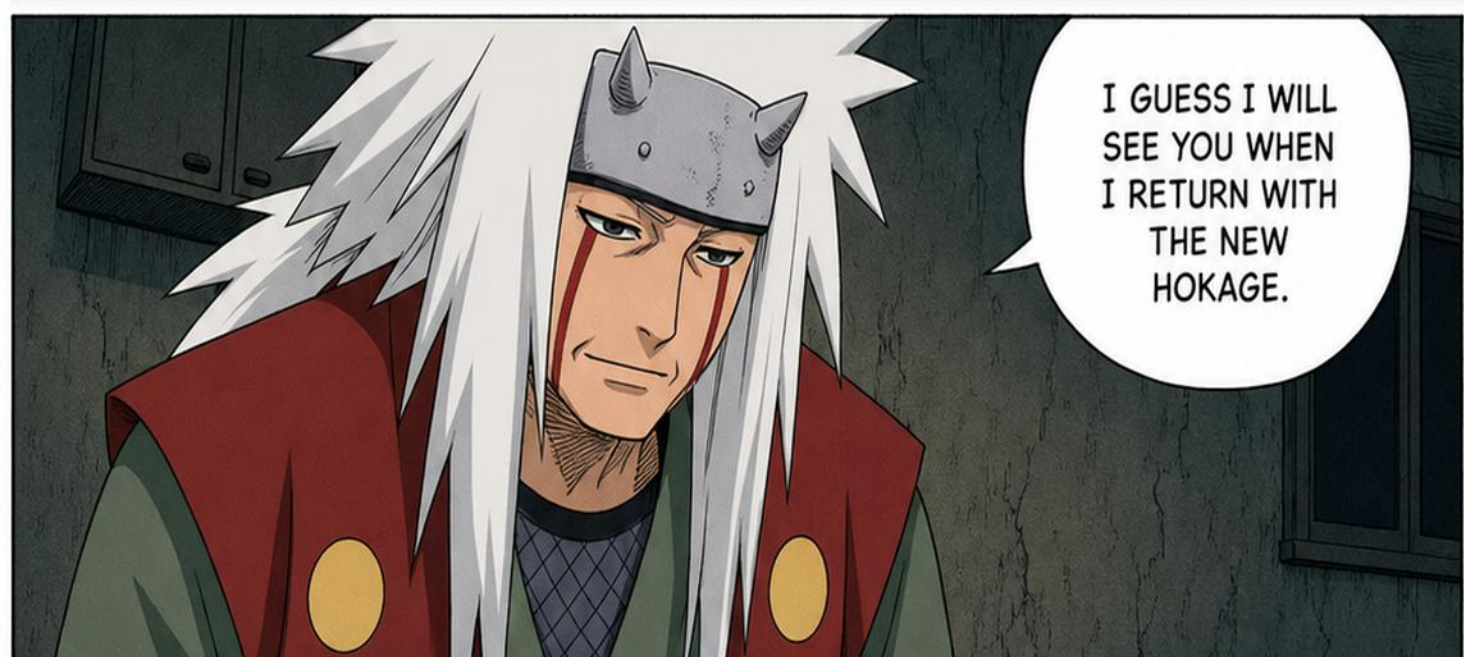
I KNOW
I SCREWED UP.
CAN'T YOU GIVE
ME A CHANCE
TO MAKE UP
FOR THAT?



I DON'T HATE
YOU FOR
ABANDONING ME.
THERE IS
NOTHING FOR
YOU TO SETTLE.



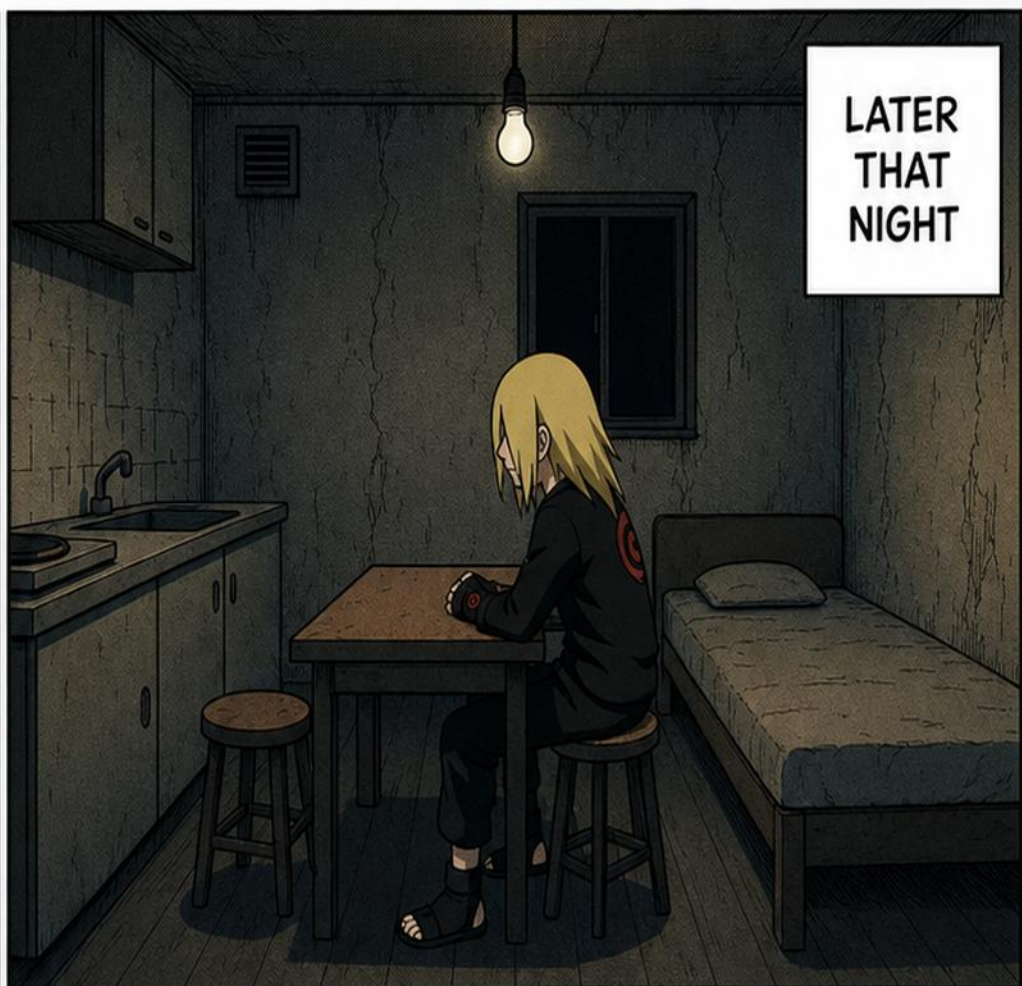
I DON'T NEED
EMOTIONAL
ATTACHMENTS
WITH YOU OR
ANYONE.



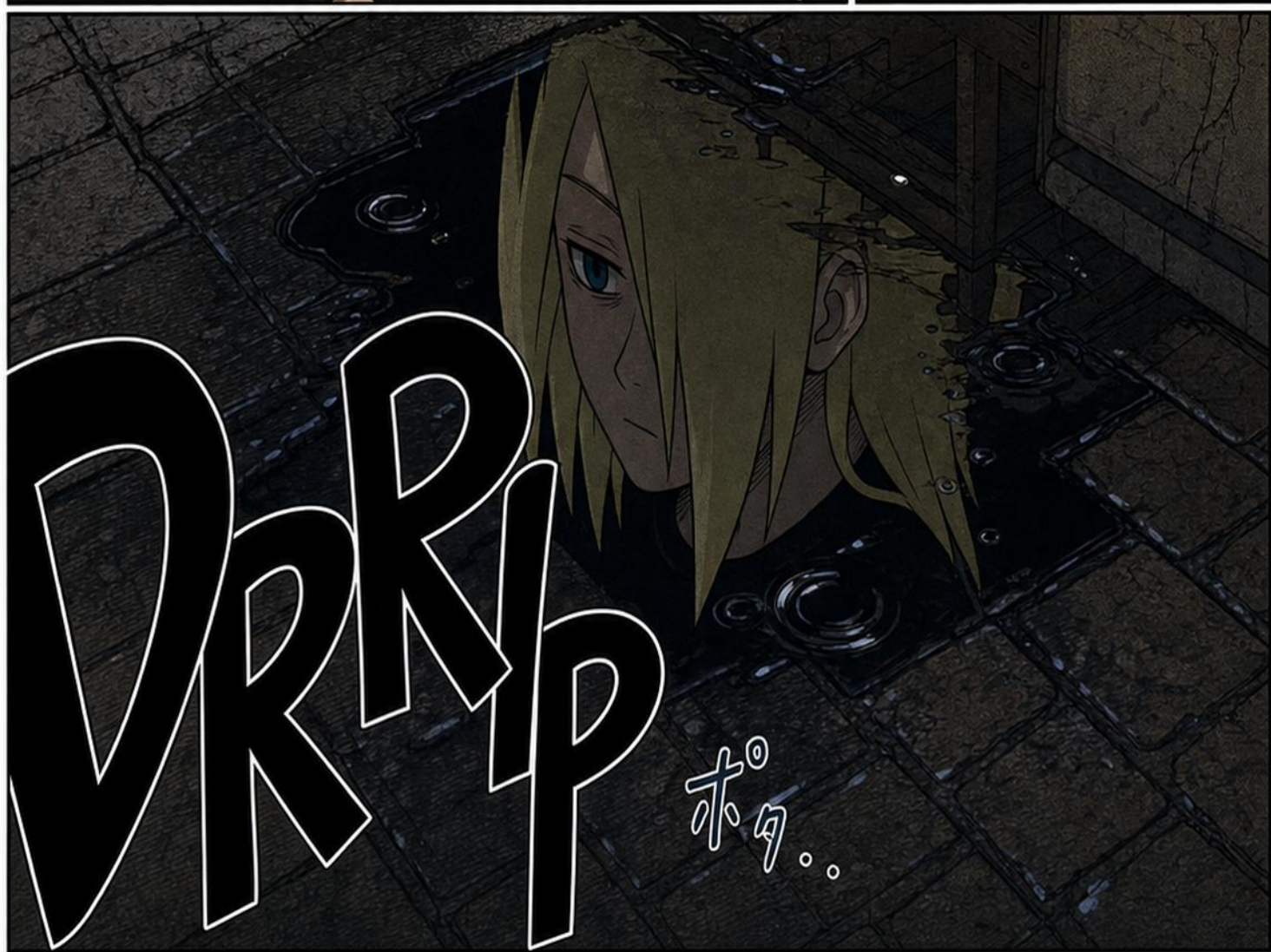
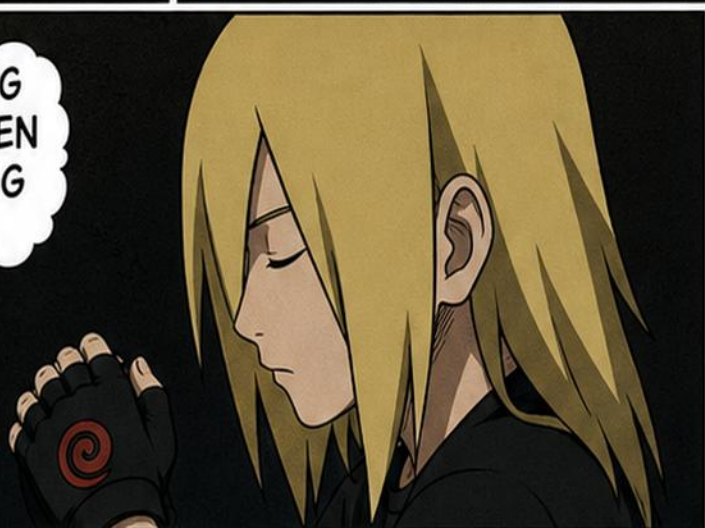
I GUESS I WILL
SEE YOU WHEN
I RETURN WITH
THE NEW
HOKAGE.

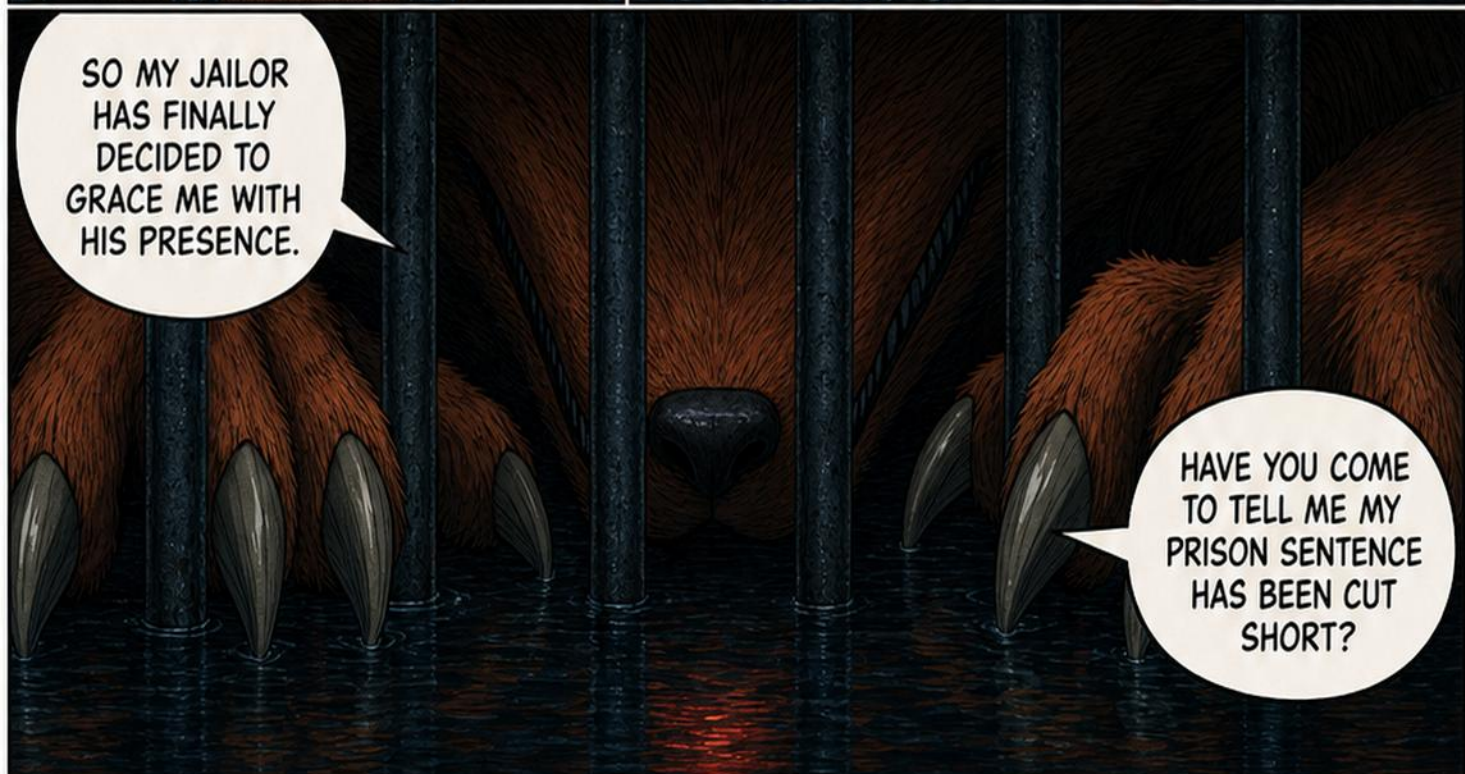
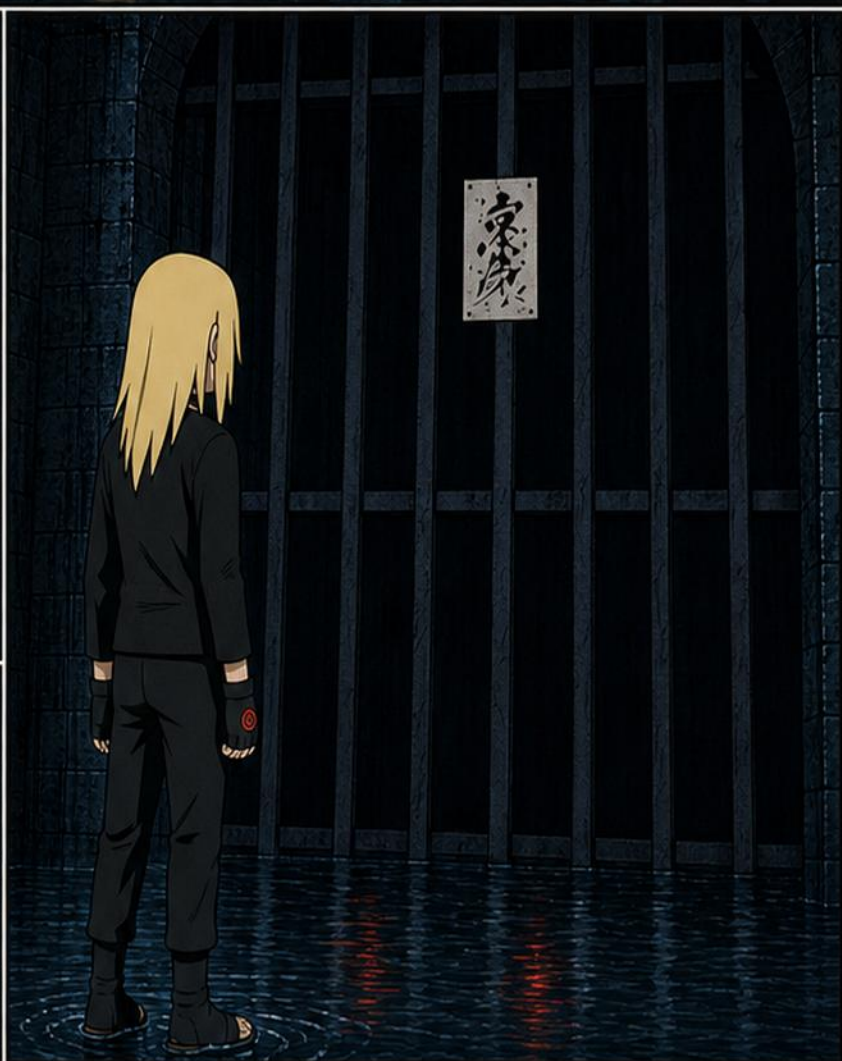
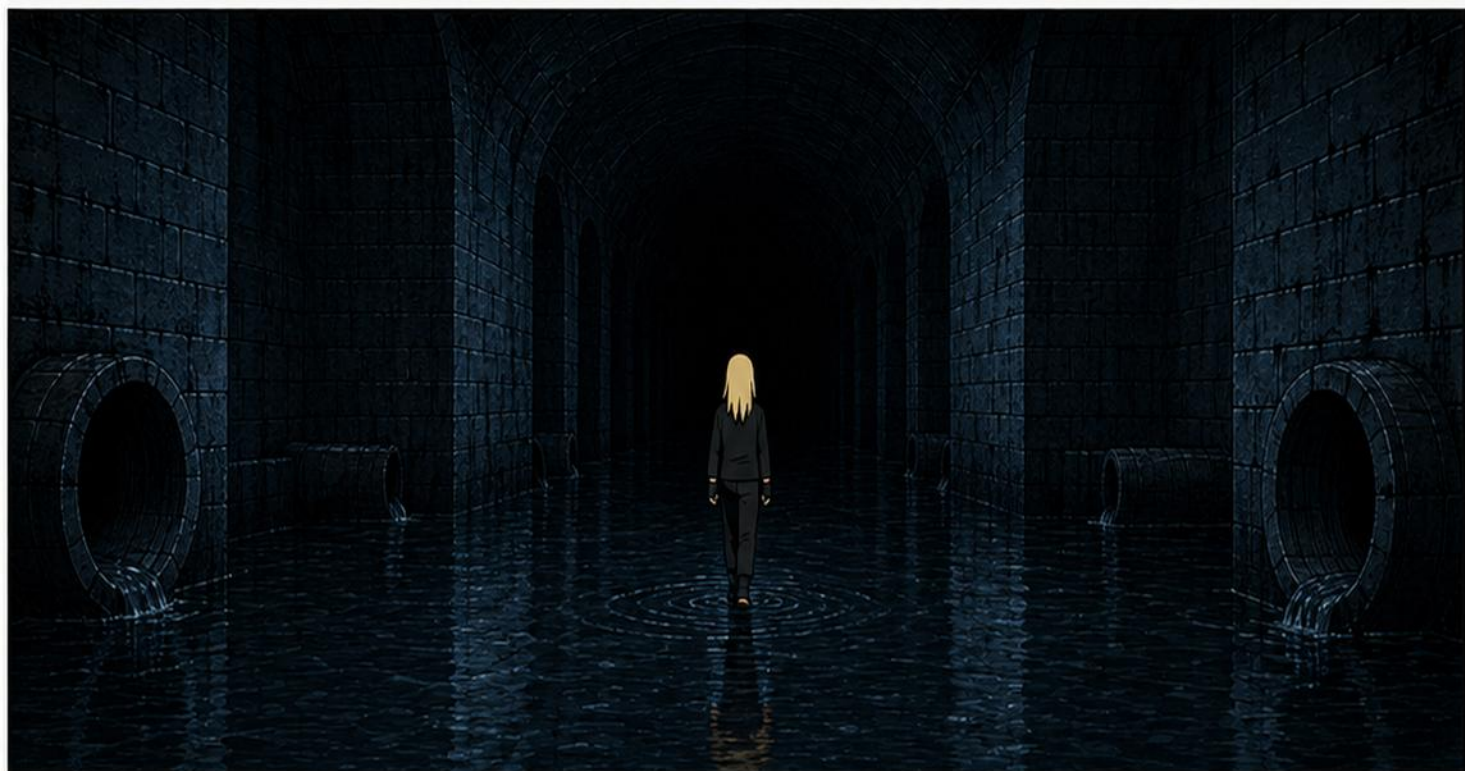


LATER
THAT
NIGHT



SOMETHING
I HAVE BEEN
RELENTING
TO DO.





SO MY JAILOR
HAS FINALLY
DECIDED TO
GRACE ME WITH
HIS PRESENCE.

HAVE YOU COME
TO TELL ME MY
PRISON SENTENCE
HAS BEEN CUT
SHORT?



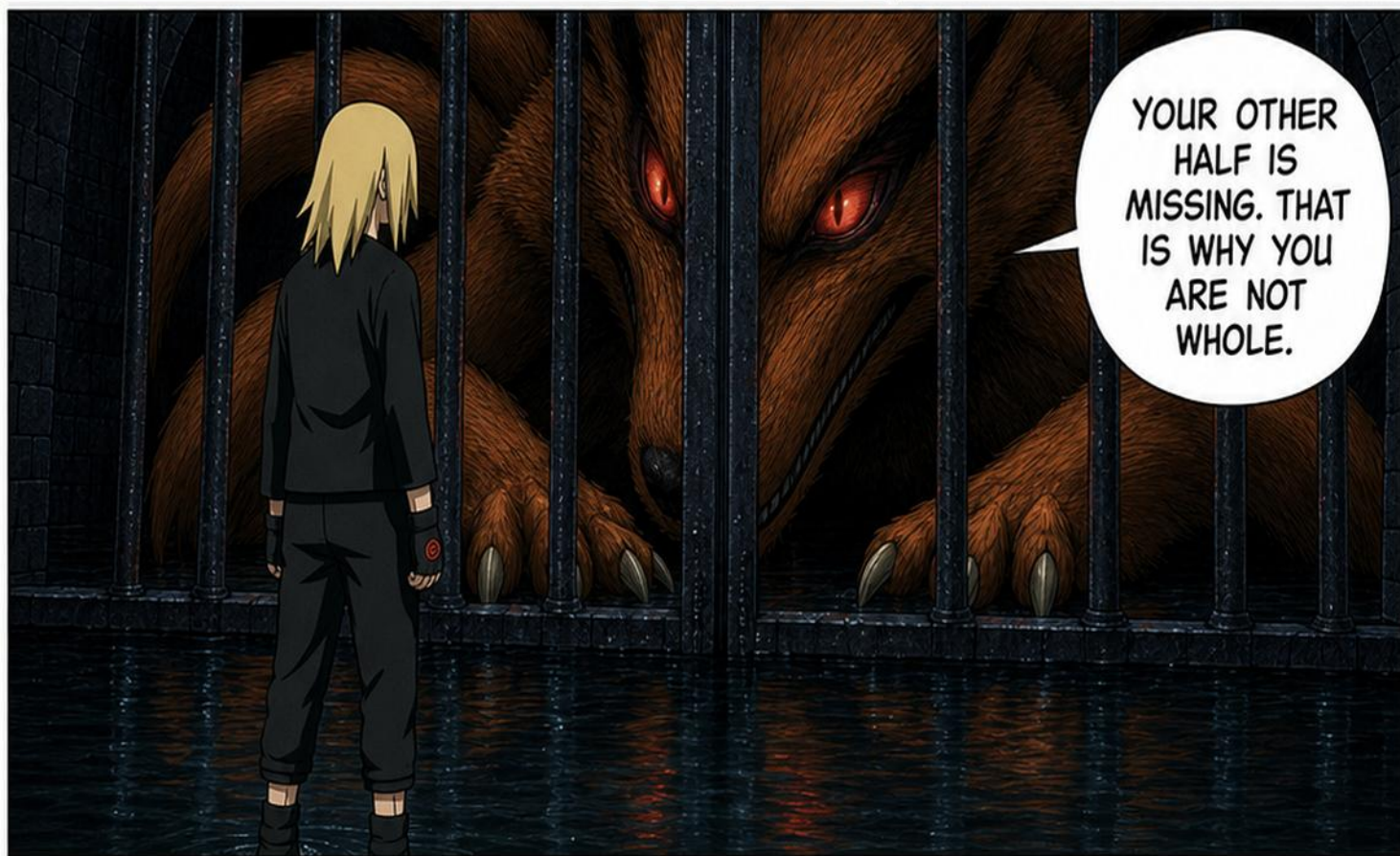
IS THIS
WHAT THE
GREAT KYUUBI
HAS BEEN
REDUCED TO?



THIS CAGE
CANNOT HOLD
ME FOREVER.



IF YOU WERE
COMPLETE, YOU
WOULD HAVE
ALREADY BROKEN
OUT.



YOUR OTHER
HALF IS
MISSING. THAT
IS WHY YOU
ARE NOT
WHOLE.

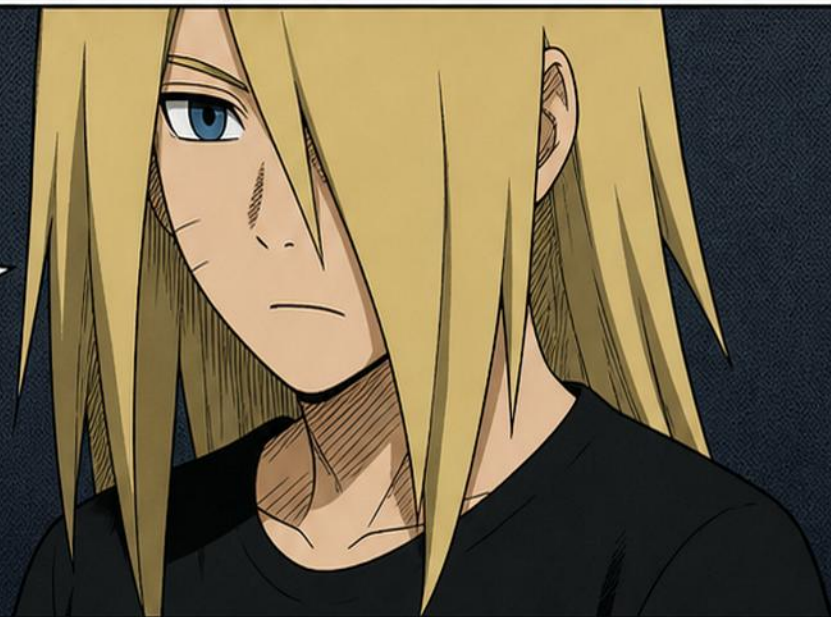
I KNOW
HUMANS TREATED
YOUR KIND AS
WEAPONS RATHER
THAN PEOPLE.



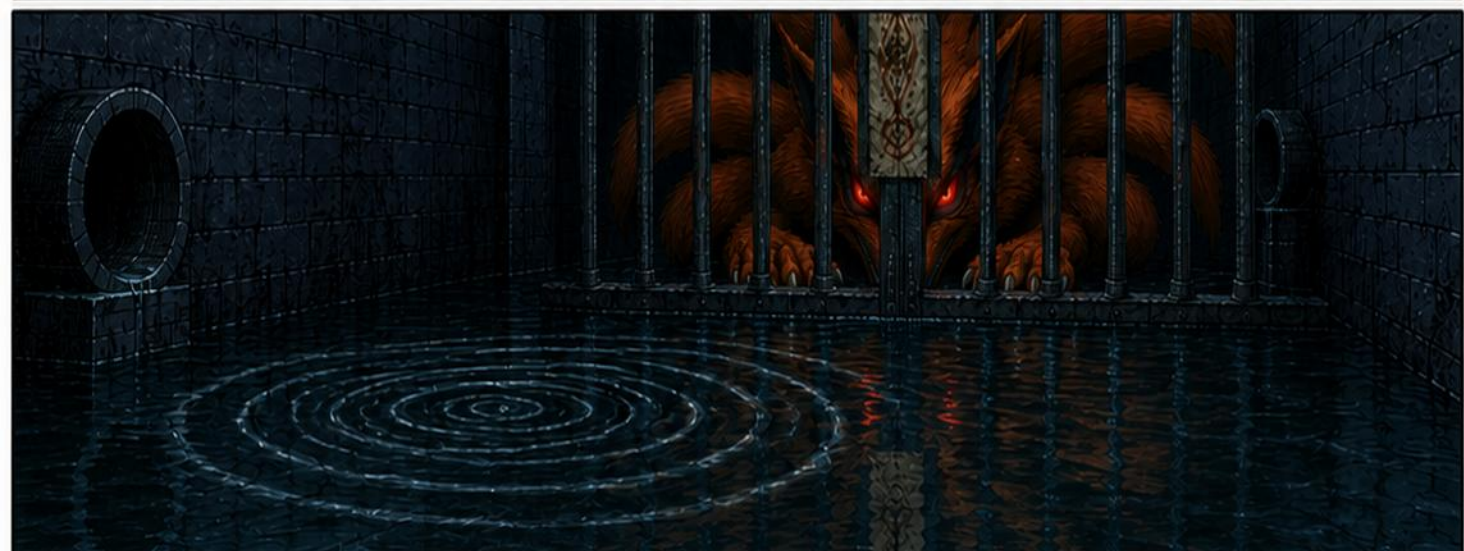
YOU ARE
NOT A
MINDLESS
BEAST THAT
NEEDS TO BE
GUIDED.

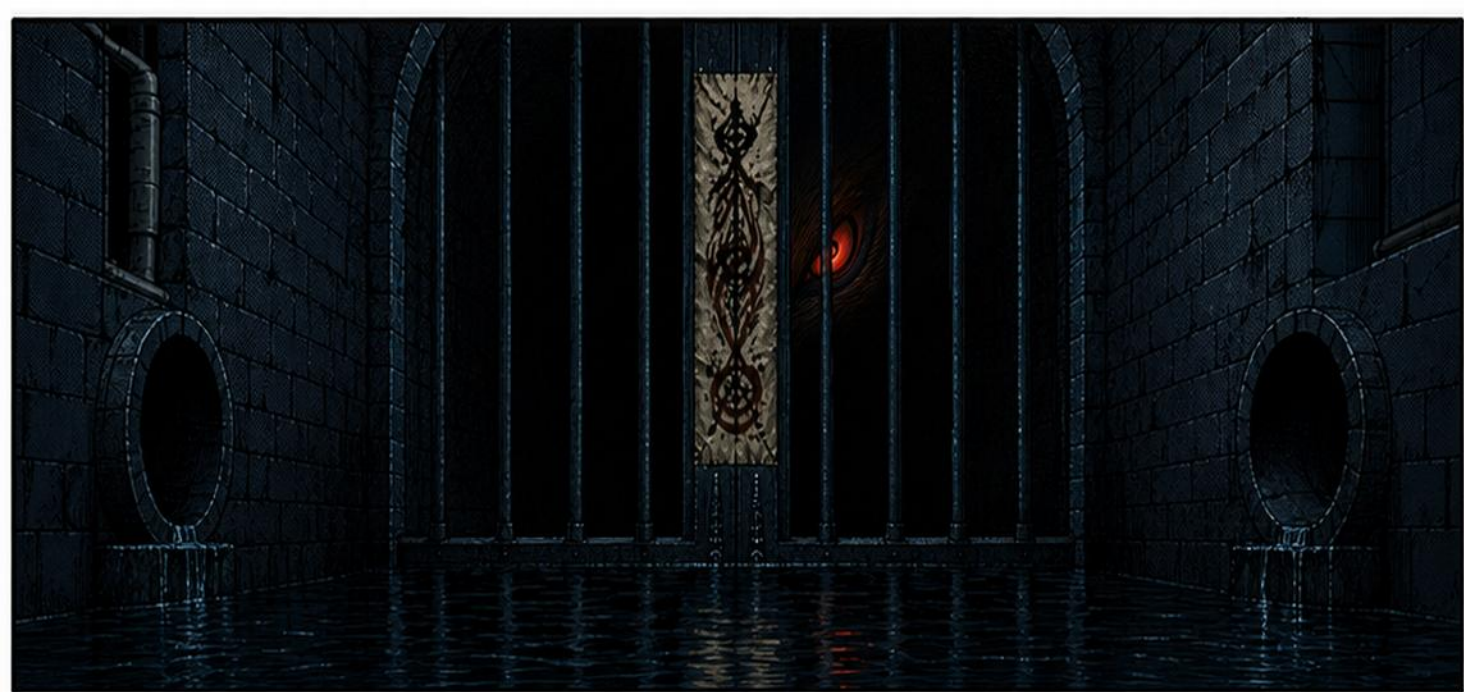


AS FOR
YOUR
IMPERFECTION,
I PLAN TO
FIX THAT.



FOR YOUR
PRISON SENTENCE,
YOU WILL HAVE
YOUR FREEDOM
SOON.





HUMANS HAD
PROVED THEY
COULD NOT BE
TRUSTED.



THE BIJUU WERE
NOTHING BUT
WEAPONS TO THEM.

